

DevArt Social Cards – User Manual

Introduction

DevArt Social Cards is a professional Joomla 6 administrator component designed to help website owners, editors, journalists, and social media managers create stunning social media image cards directly from Joomla articles.

Instead of using external design software every time you publish content, DevArt Social Cards allows you to generate ready-to-post branded graphics inside Joomla within seconds.

The extension is especially useful for:

- News websites
- Online magazines
- Sports portals
- Local newspapers
- Corporate websites
- Blogs
- Social media teams
- High-volume editorial websites

Main Purpose of DevArt Social Cards

The component converts Joomla article content into professional social media graphics using automated templates.

It can instantly use:

- Joomla article title
- Joomla intro image
- Custom subtitle text
- Branding logo
- Custom badge labels
- Social-media optimized output sizes

This allows you to publish visually attractive content faster on:

- Facebook
- Instagram
- X / Twitter
- LinkedIn
- Telegram channels
- News feeds
- Promotional campaigns

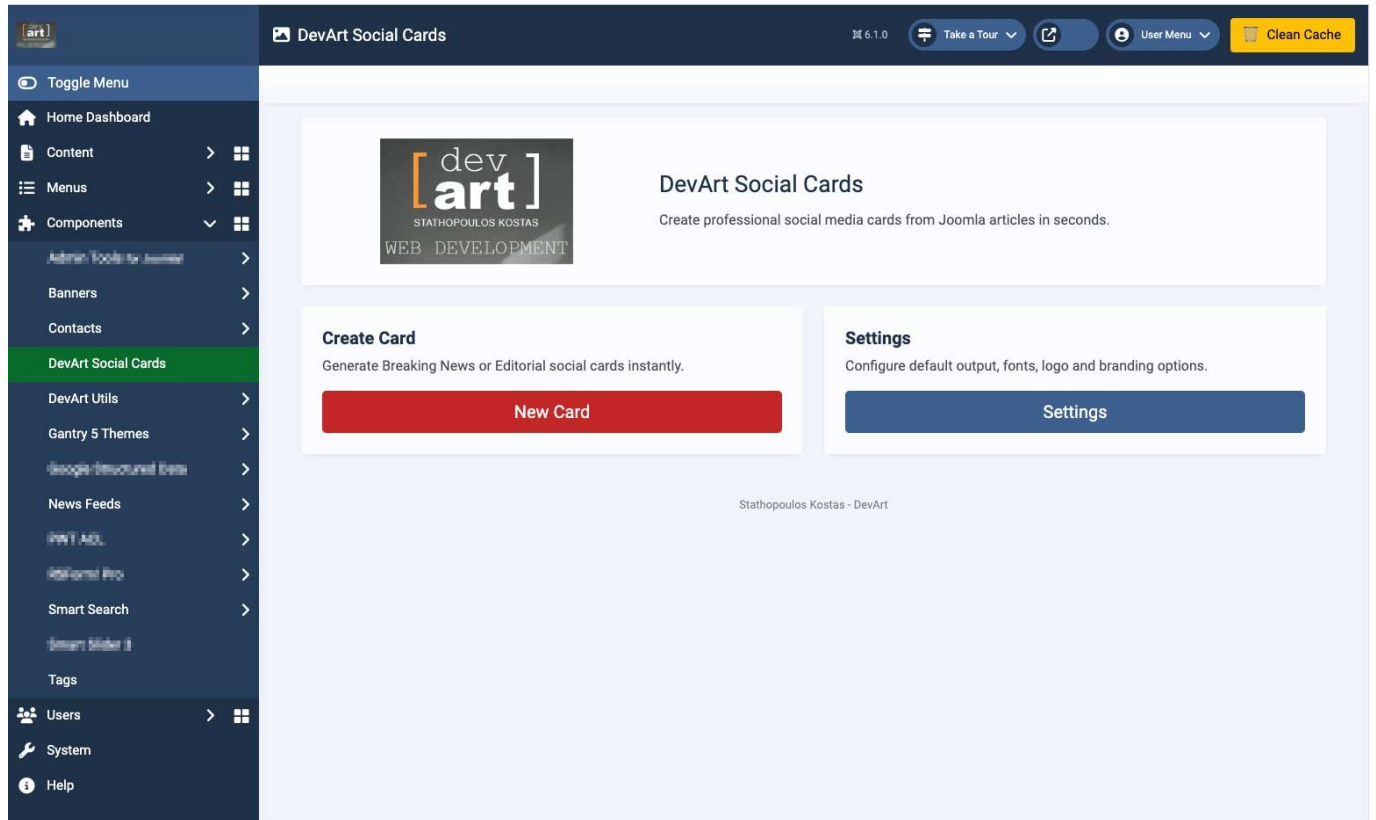
Dashboard Overview

Go to:

Components → DevArt Social Cards

The dashboard is the central control panel of the extension.

It is designed to be clean, fast, and simple so administrators can begin working immediately.



Create Card Panel

Main button:

New Card

This opens the Social Card Generator.

Use it when you want to create:

- Breaking News graphics
- Editorial post images
- Sports cards
- Facebook link images
- Fast article visuals

Settings Panel

Main button:

Settings

This opens the configuration panel where you can control default values and behavior.

Examples:

- Default badge text
- Default badge color
- Default font
- Default logo
- Output quality
- Permissions

Recommended for first-time setup.

Typical Daily Workflow

For most publishers:

1. Open DevArt Social Cards
2. Click **New Card**
3. Select Joomla article
4. Auto-load title + image
5. Preview card live
6. Generate final image
7. Post to social media

Benefits for Joomla Websites

Using DevArt Social Cards helps you:

- Publish faster
- Improve article visibility on social media
- Maintain brand consistency
- Save graphic design time
- Produce professional visuals daily
- Increase click-through rates

Recommended For

Especially valuable for:

- Joomla news portals

- Regional newspapers
- Sports websites
- Content agencies
- Magazine publishers
- Marketing teams
- Solo website owners

Settings – Configuration Guide

Introduction

The **Settings** area allows administrators to define the default behavior of DevArt Social Cards.

Instead of manually changing options every time a new card is created, you can pre-configure your preferred values once and use them automatically for future projects.

Go to:

Components → DevArt Social Cards → Settings

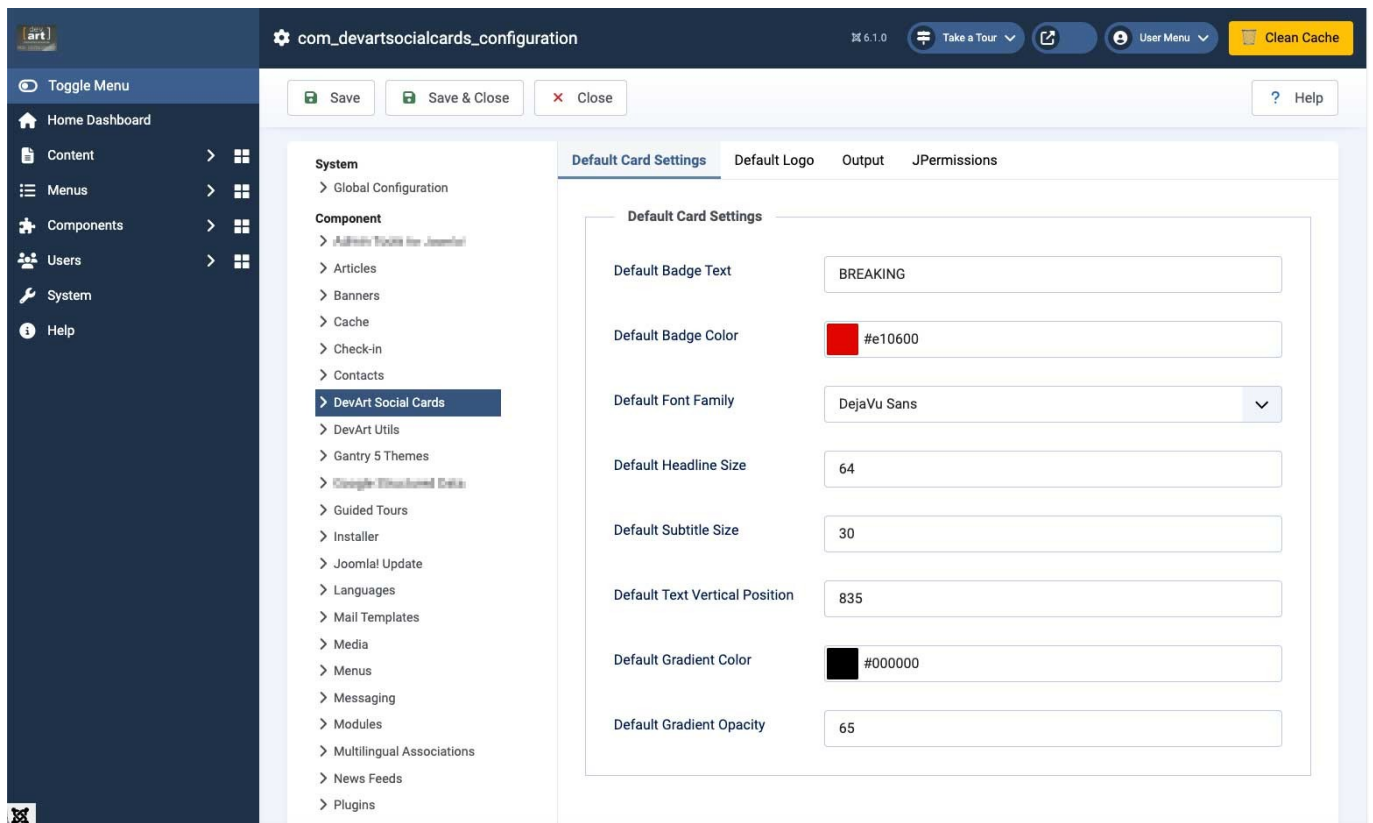
The configuration page is divided into four main sections:

- Default Card Settings
- Default Logo
- Output
- Permissions

1. Default Card Settings

This section controls the visual defaults used when opening the card generator.

These values are automatically preloaded inside the Create Card page.



Default Badge Text

Sets the default badge label shown on cards.

Examples:

- BREAKING
- NEWS
- SPORTS
- ALERT
- LIVE

Useful for publishers who regularly use the same category style.

Default Badge Color

Defines the badge background color.

Examples:

- Red for Breaking News
- Blue for Politics
- Green for Sports
- Yellow for Alerts

This helps maintain brand consistency.

Default Font Family

Selects the default font used in generated cards.

Available fonts depend on installed package fonts.

Used for:

- Headlines
- Subtitles
- Badge text

Recommended: choose a clean readable font for social media.

Default Headline Size

Defines the starting font size for article titles.

Larger values:

- Stronger impact
- Better for short headlines

Smaller values:

- Better for long headlines

Default Subtitle Size

Controls subtitle text size.

Useful when you frequently include teaser descriptions under the main title.

Default Text Vertical Position

Moves the text block higher or lower on the image.

Use it to avoid conflicts with:

- Faces
- Important photo areas
- Logos
- Background clutter

Very useful for news photography.

Default Gradient Color

Defines the overlay color placed above the image background.

Usually:

- Black for readability
- Dark blue for branding

- Dark red for dramatic style

Default Gradient Opacity

Controls transparency strength of the overlay.

Lower values:

- More visible photo

Higher values:

- Stronger text contrast

Recommended range:

40–75 depending on image brightness.

Why This Section Matters

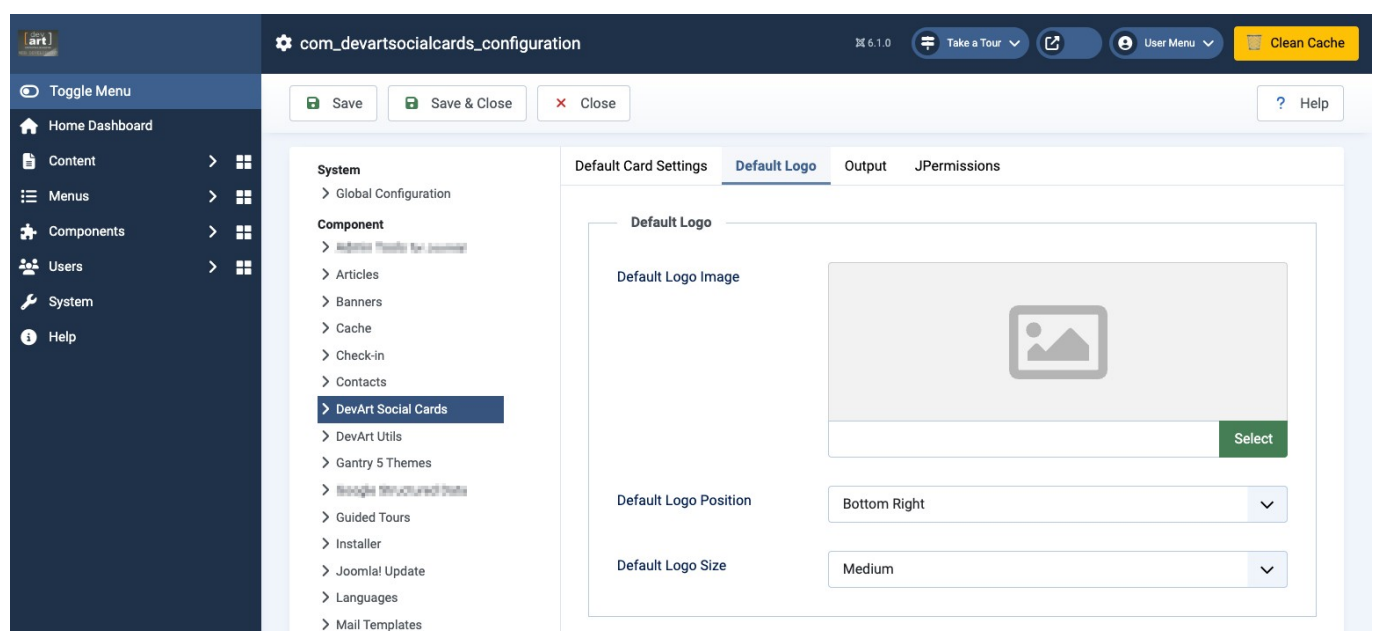
These defaults save time when producing many cards every day.

Ideal for:

- Newsrooms
- Sports sites
- Content teams
- High-volume publishers

2. Default Logo

This section defines branding that can automatically appear on generated cards.



Default Logo Image

Choose a logo file from Joomla Media Manager.

Typical examples:

- Website logo
- News brand logo
- Sports channel logo
- Company brand mark

Once saved, it can be reused automatically.

Default Logo Position

Controls where the logo appears.

Usually:

- Bottom Right
- Bottom Left
- Top Right

Recommended:

Bottom Right for news cards.

Default Logo Size

Defines logo display size.

Available sizes usually include:

- Small
- Medium
- Large

Use medium for most cards.

Why Logo Defaults Help

Automatic branding ensures:

- Consistent identity
- Faster publishing
- Better recognition on social feeds

3. Output

This section controls image export quality.

JPEG Quality

Defines final image compression quality.

Higher values:

- Better image quality
- Larger file size

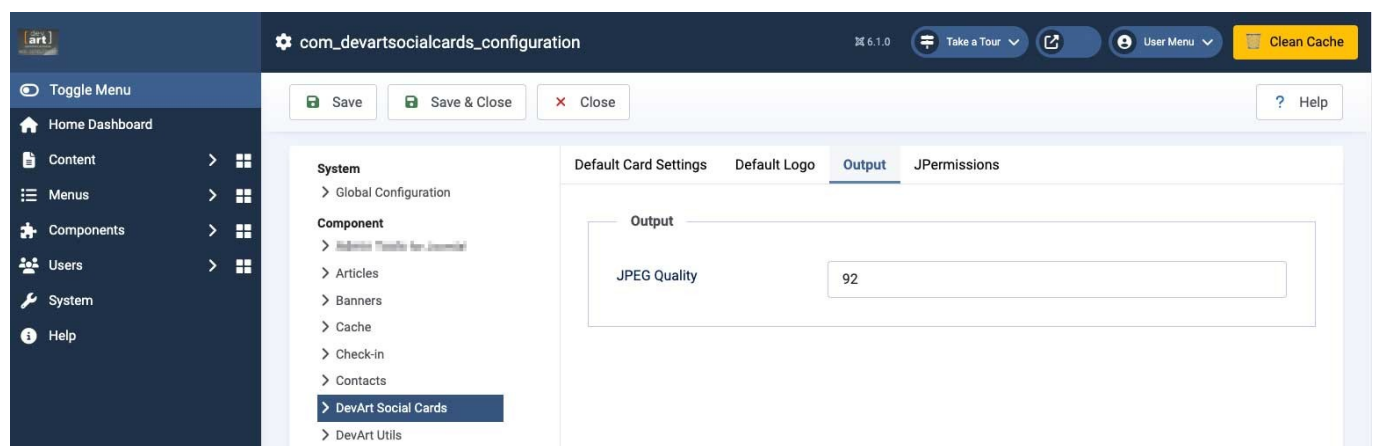
Lower values:

- Smaller files
- Faster upload speed

Recommended values:

- 88–92 for balanced quality
- 95 for premium output
- 80 for lightweight fast publishing

Default value **92** is an excellent balance.



Why Output Settings Matter

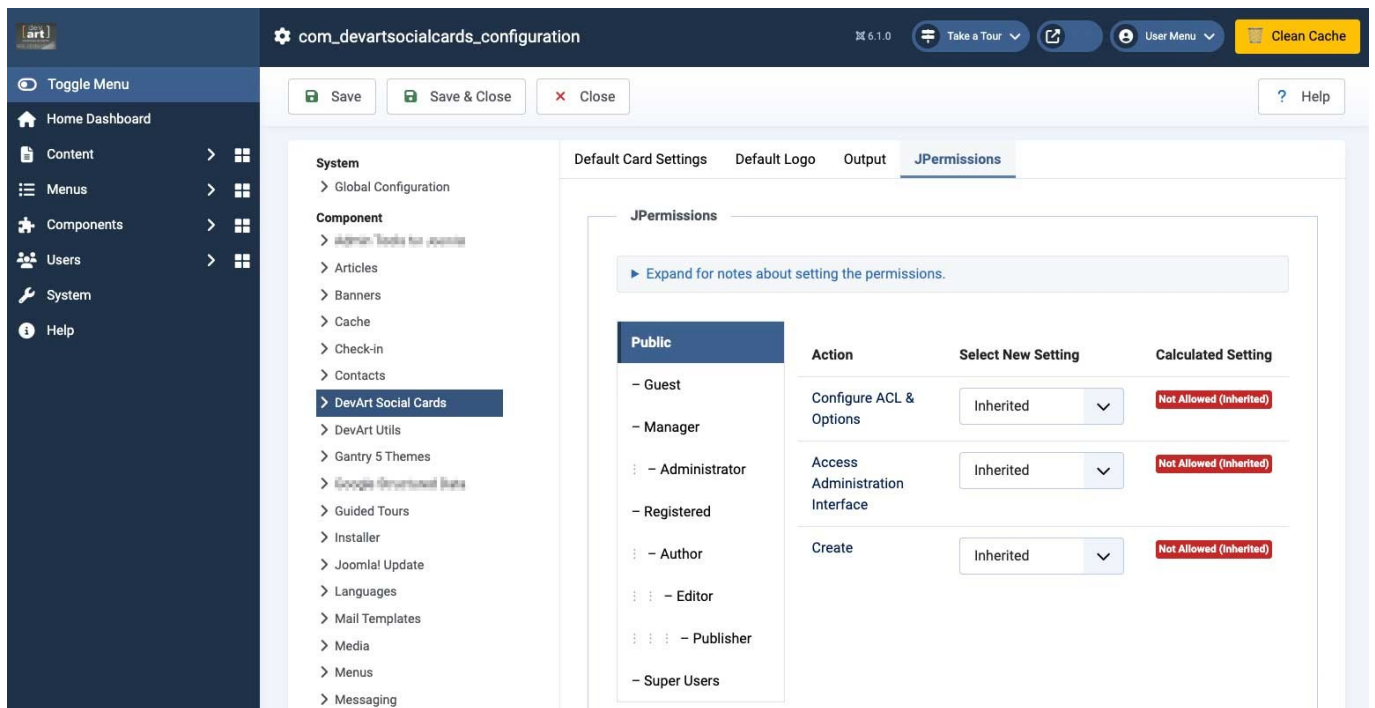
Optimized images help with:

- Faster social uploads
- Better visual quality
- Lower storage usage
- Faster website downloads

4. Permissions

This section uses Joomla ACL system.

You can decide which user groups may access or manage DevArt Social Cards.



Example Recommended ACL Setup

Super Users

Full access.

Administrators

Access + Create.

Editors

Create only.

Authors

No access.

Recommended First-Time Setup

For a professional Joomla website:

Default Card Settings

- Badge: BREAKING
- Font: Clean Sans Serif

- Headline Size: 64
- Gradient: Black
- Opacity: 65

Logo

- Bottom Right
- Medium size

Output

- JPEG Quality: 92

Permissions

- Editors can create cards
- Admin controls settings

Final Result

Once configured, every new card starts with your preferred professional layout automatically.

This dramatically speeds up daily publishing workflow.

Create Card – How to Build a Social Media Card

Introduction

The **Create Card** section is the main production area of DevArt Social Cards.

From here you can generate professional images for:

- Breaking News
- Editorial Posts
- Sports Stories
- Facebook Shares
- Instagram Posts
- Promotional Announcements

Everything is created visually with live preview.

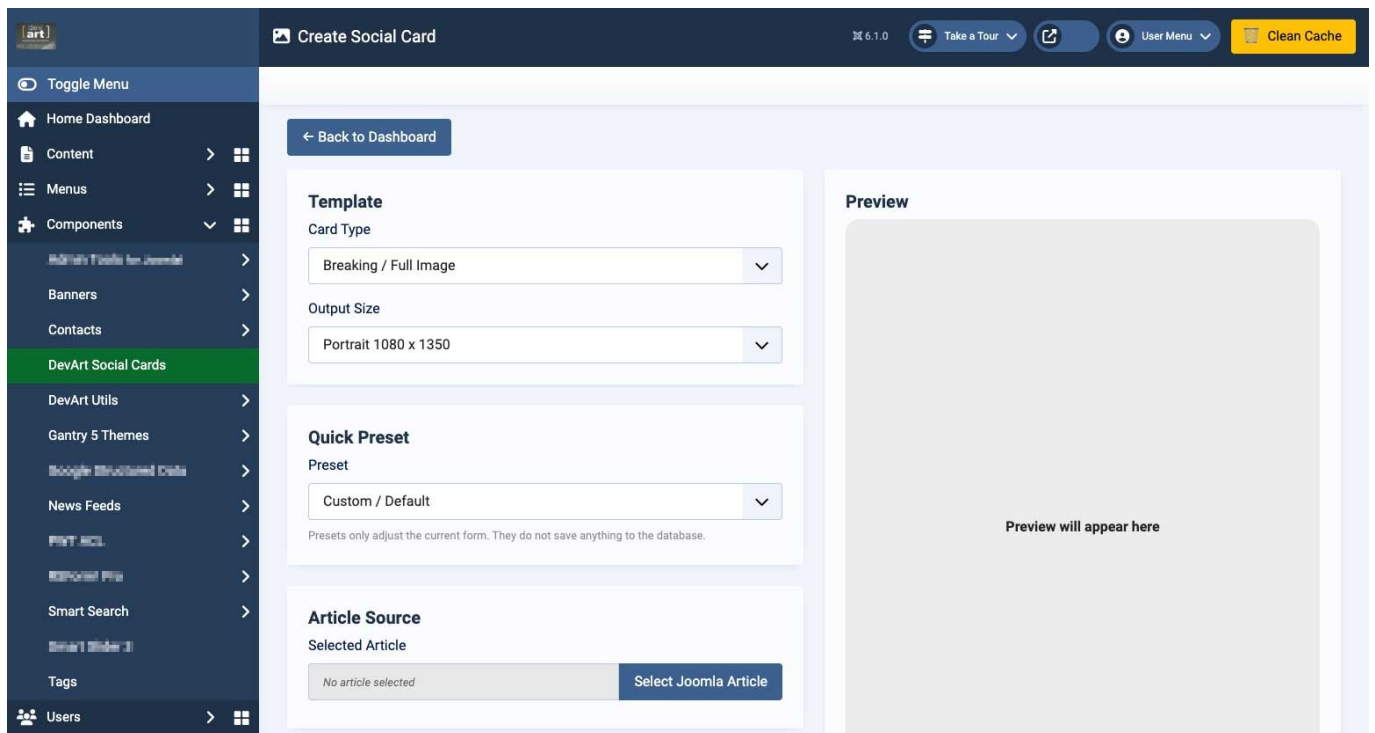
Go to:

Components → DevArt Social Cards → New Card

Workflow Overview

Creating a card usually follows this order:

1. Choose Template
2. Select Output Size
3. Choose Quick Preset
4. Load Joomla Article (optional)
5. Edit Headline & Subtitle
6. Adjust Image / Overlay / Logo
7. Preview Result
8. Generate Final Card



1. Back to Dashboard

At the top of the page, the **Back to Dashboard** button returns to the main control panel.

Useful when switching between settings and card creation.

2. Template Selection

Card Type

Choose the visual style of the card.

Breaking / Full Image

Best for:

- Urgent news
- Sports
- Dramatic headlines
- Eye-catching social media posts

Uses full background image with overlay text.

Clean News / Editorial

Best for:

- Serious journalism
- Analysis
- Interviews
- Corporate posts

Uses a cleaner structured layout with image + text area.

3. Output Size

Choose final image dimensions.

Available sizes:

Portrait 1080 x 1350

Best for:

- Instagram posts
- Facebook feed visibility
- High engagement mobile format

Square 1080 x 1080

Best for:

- General social posting
- Balanced layout

Facebook Link 1200 x 630

Best for:

- Shared links
- Website article previews

Landscape 1200 x 800

Best for:

- Blog promotions
- Website banners

4. Quick Presets

Presets instantly apply a ready-made visual style.

Examples:

Breaking Red

Classic urgent news style.

Politics Blue

Professional political coverage look.

Sports Green

Perfect for sports headlines.

Dark Minimal Black

Modern premium style.

Alert Yellow

Strong warning / alert style.

Presets only affect current form values and do not modify settings permanently.

5. Article Source

One of the most powerful features.

Select Joomla Article

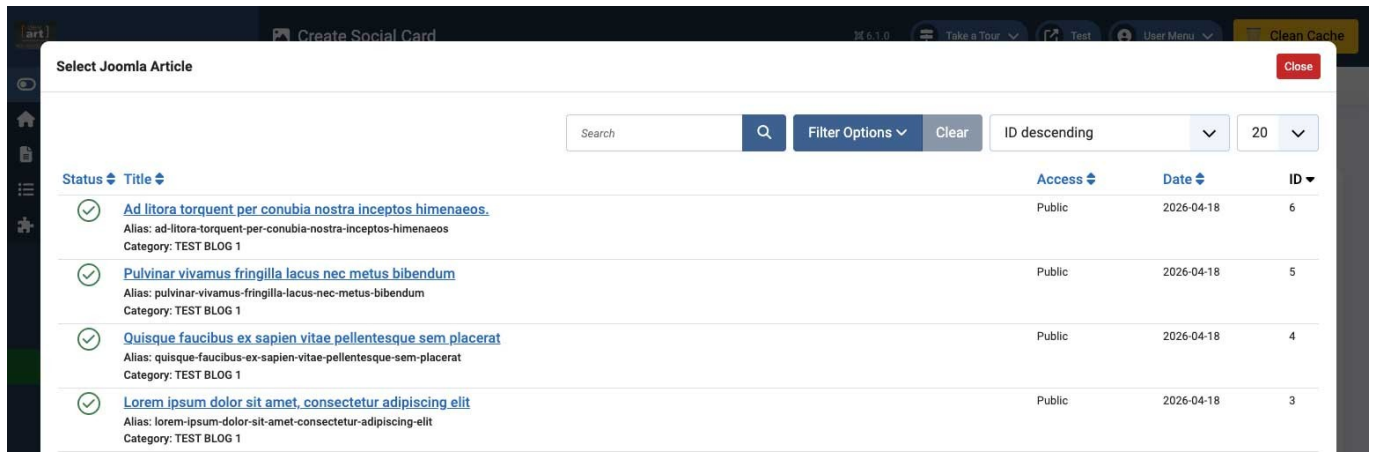
Click **Select Joomla Article** to open Joomla article picker.

Then choose any existing article.

The system can automatically load:

- Article title
- Intro text
- Intro image (when available)

This saves time and keeps consistency with published content.



6. Preview Panel

Right side of the page shows live preview.

This allows instant visual adjustments before export.

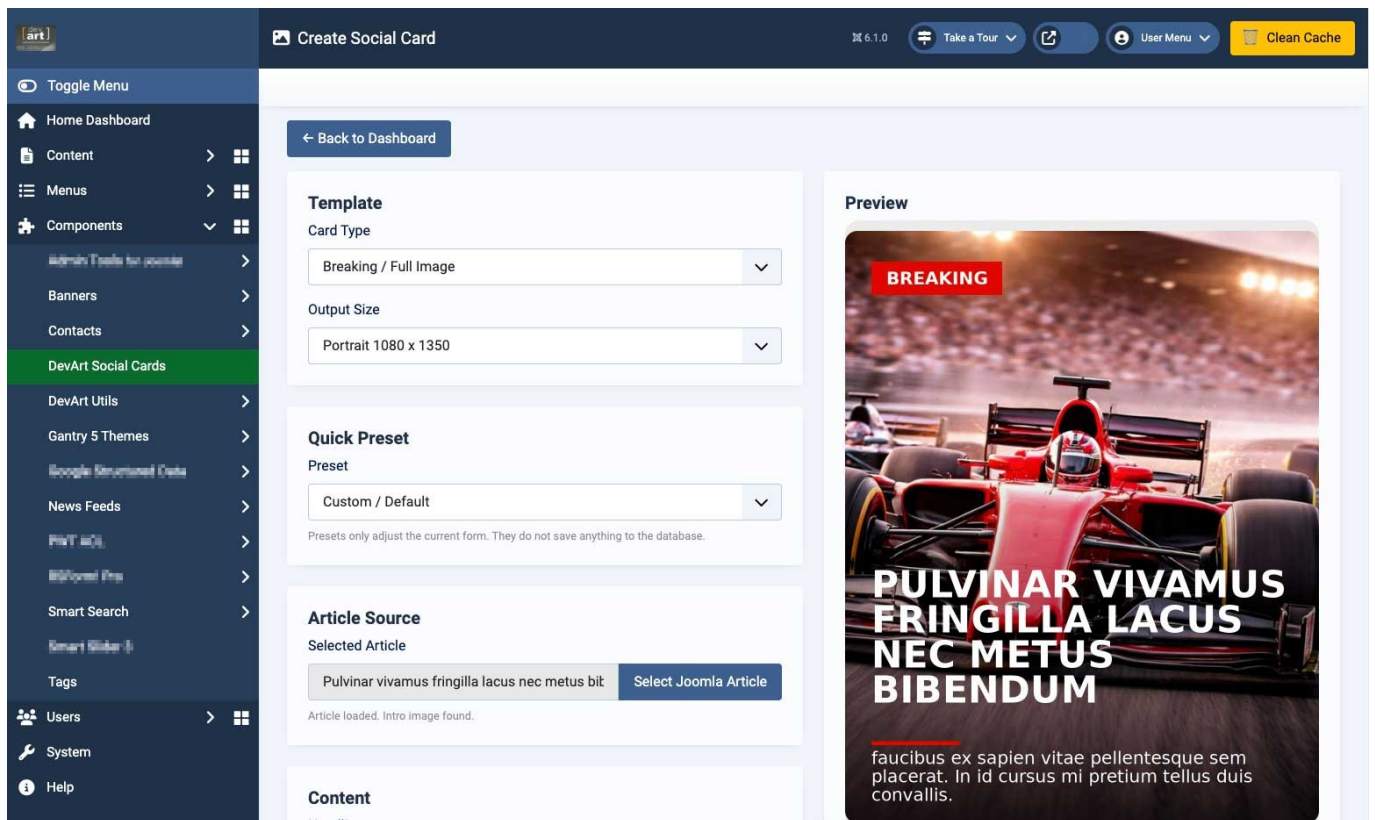
Auto Preview

When enabled, preview refreshes automatically after edits.

Useful during design fine-tuning.

Update Preview

Manual refresh button if Auto Preview is disabled.



7. Content Section

Headline

Main title shown on the card.

Tips:

- Keep short and strong
- Use action words
- Focus on impact

Headline Size

Adjust title font size.

Use:

- Larger for short titles
- Smaller for long titles

Subtitle

Secondary supporting text.

Useful for:

- Summary
- Context
- Extra detail

Subtitle Size

Controls subtitle readability.

Text Vertical Position

Moves text block up or down.

Very useful to avoid faces or important image areas.

Font Family

Choose typography style.

Clean modern fonts usually perform best on social media.

Badge

Small category label shown above headline.

Examples:

- BREAKING
- NEWS
- SPORTS
- LIVE
- EXCLUSIVE

Badge Color

Sets badge background color.

Use strong branding colors.

8. Image Section

Upload Image

Upload your own background image.

Supported formats typically include:

- JPG
- PNG
- WEBP

If no image is uploaded, article intro image can be used automatically.

Image Position

Controls crop alignment:

- Center
- Top
- Bottom
- Left
- Right

Useful when subject is not centered.

Zoom

Zooms image in or out.

Helpful for improving composition.

9. Overlay Section

Gradient Color

Color overlay above image.

Usually black for readability.

Opacity

Controls darkness strength.

Higher opacity:

- Stronger text visibility

Lower opacity:

- More visible photo detail

10. Logo Section

Upload Logo

Add your website or brand logo.

Position

Common choices:

- Bottom Right
- Bottom Left
- Top Right

Size

- Small
- Medium
- Large

Use medium for most cards.

11. Generate Final Card

Generate Card Button

Creates downloadable final image using current settings.

Use this after preview looks correct.

Recommended Fast Workflow

For Daily News Sites

1. Select Breaking Template
2. Pick Article
3. Adjust headline if needed
4. Click Generate Card

Time required: under 20 seconds.

Recommended Editorial Workflow

1. Choose Clean News Template
2. Upload custom photo
3. Write strong headline
4. Add subtitle
5. Use blue preset
6. Generate final image

For Higher CTR on Facebook

Use:

- Large bold headline
- Strong contrast

- Human faces
- Red or blue badges

For Instagram

Use:

- Portrait 1080x1350
- Minimal subtitle
- Strong visual photo

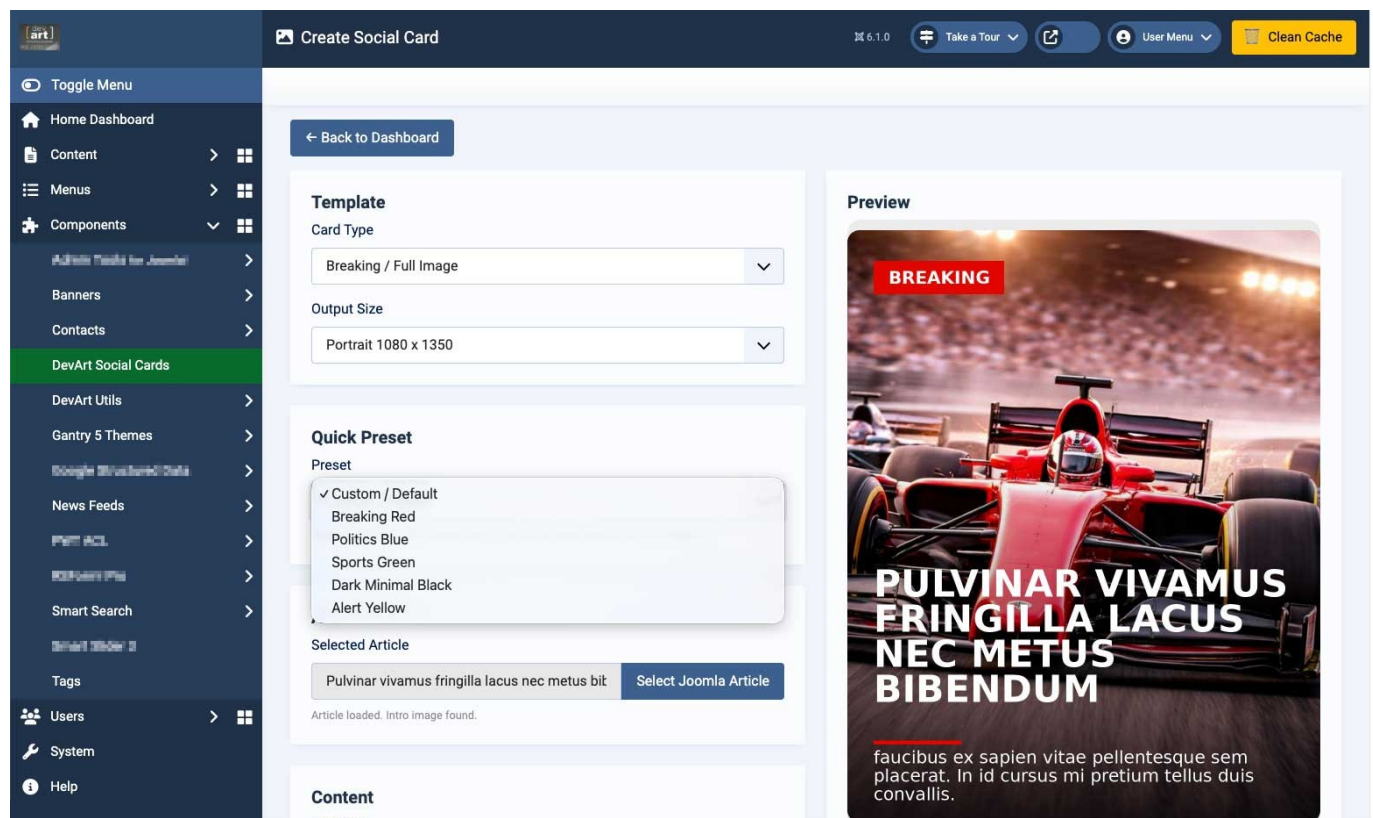
For Serious News Brands

Use:

- Clean template
- Blue preset
- Moderate headline size
- Logo branding

Final Result

DevArt Social Cards transforms Joomla articles into social-ready graphics in seconds without Photoshop or external tools.



art

Toggle Menu

Home Dashboard

Content

Menus

Components

Admin Tools for Joomla!

Banners

Contacts

DevArt Social Cards

DevArt Utils

Gantry 5 Themes

Google Structured Data

News Feeds

PHP ACL

PHPForm Pro

Smart Search

Smart Slider 3

Tags

Users

System

Help

Create Social Card

6.1.0

Take a Tour

User Menu

Clean Cache

Back to Dashboard

Template

Card Type

Breaking / Full Image

Output Size

Portrait 1080 x 1350

Square 1080 x 1080

Facebook Link 1200 x 630

Landscape 1200 x 800

Quick Preset

Preset

Custom / Default

Presets only adjust the current form. They do not save anything to the database.

Article Source

Selected Article

Pulvinar vivamus fringilla lacus nec metus bit

Select Joomla Article

Article loaded. Intro image found.

Content

Headline

Preview

BREAKING

PULVINAR VIVAMUS FRINGILLA LACUS NEC METUS BIBENDUM

faucibus ex sapien vitae pellentesque sem placerat. In id cursus mi pretium tellus duis convallis.

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Selected Article

Pulvinar vivamus fringilla lacus nec metus bit

Select Joomla Article

Article loaded. Intro image found.

Preview

BREAKING

PULVINAR VIVAMUS FRINGILLA LACUS NEC METUS BIBENDUM

faucibus ex sapien vitae pellentesque sem placerat. In id cursus mi pretium tellus duis convallis.

System

Help

Content

Headline

Pulvinar vivamus fringilla lacus nec metus bibendum

Headline Size

Subtitle

faucibus ex sapien vitae pellentesque sem placerat. In id cursus mi pretium tellus dui convallis.

Subtitle Size

Text Vertical Position

Font Family

Roboto Condensed

Badge

BREAKING

Badge Color

Auto Preview

Generate Card

Update Preview

Image

Upload Image

Επιλογή αρχείου

Δεν επιλέχθηκε κανένα αρχείο.

If no image is uploaded, the selected article intro image will be used when available.

Image Position

Center

Zoom

Overlay

Gradient Color

Opacity

Logo

Upload Logo

Επιλογή αρχείου

Δεν επιλέχθηκε κανένα αρχείο.

Position

Bottom Right

Size

Medium